# Learn to write the Hebrew letters

Hebrew is written and read from **right to left**. In every practice row, the first (black) model letter is at the **right**: trace it, then keep writing to the left. The letters fade from solid grey, to dotted, to empty, so you finish by writing on your own.

## How to use this workbook

1. Look at the stroke-order page at the start of each section. The numbers show the order; the arrow shows where each stroke ends.
2. In each row, trace the grey and dotted letters, then fill the empty space.
3. Tick the box at the left of the row when you can write that letter **3 times without looking** at the model.
4. Colour in one circle in the progress chart below each time you do that (three circles per letter).

**DRAFT:** stroke order not yet reviewed by a native teacher. The numbered strokes in this workbook were computed from fonts and checked only against one outside reference; if your teacher shows a different order, follow your teacher. Cursive shapes come from the font Gveret Levin (Israeli handwriting style); real handwriting also joins and varies.

## My progress (27 letters, right to left)

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9. Tet ○○○ | 8. Chet ○○○ | 7. Zayin ○○○ | 6. Vav ○○○ | 5. He ○○○ | 4. Dalet ○○○ | 3. Gimel ○○○ | 2. Bet ○○○ | 1. Alef ○○○ |
| 18. Tsadi ○○○ | 17. Pe ○○○ | 16. Ayin ○○○ | 15. Samekh ○○○ | 14. Nun ○○○ | 13. Mem ○○○ | 12. Lamed ○○○ | 11. Kaf ○○○ | 10. Yod ○○○ |
| 27. Tsadi sofit ○○○ | 26. Pe sofit ○○○ | 25. Nun sofit ○○○ | 24. Mem sofit ○○○ | 23. Kaf sofit ○○○ | 22. Tav ○○○ | 21. Shin ○○○ | 20. Resh ○○○ | 19. Qof ○○○ |

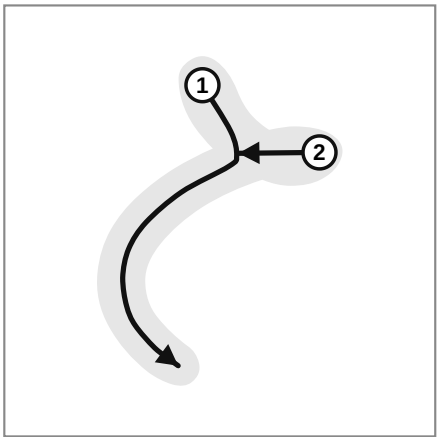
**Memory hooks (DRAFT):** the italic line on each row is a sound-alike memory trick, not the history of the letter, and has not been checked by a Hebrew teacher.

* The values 500-900 for the five final (sofit) letters are a widely used convention, not confirmed by a source consulted here. Gematria = the number value of a letter. Letters with two sounds (Bet/Vet, Kaf/Khaf, Pe/Fe, Shin/Sin) have two rows; the row marked "b" is the second sound.

## Letters 1-9: Alef, Bet, Gimel, Dalet, He, Vav, Zayin, Chet, Tet

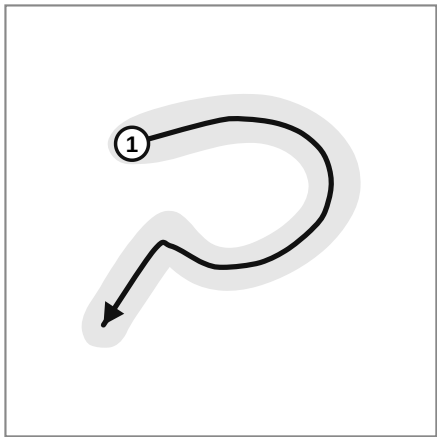
Circle with a number = where each stroke starts; arrowhead = where it ends. **Draft order, not teacher-reviewed.**

**Gimel**



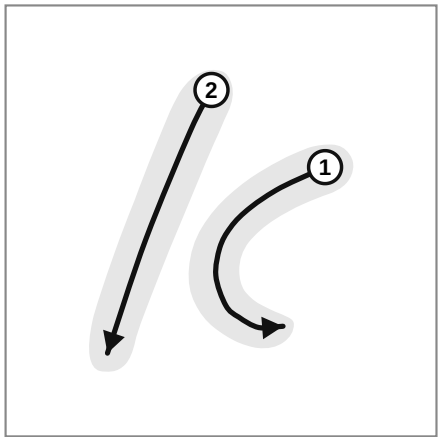

2 strokes

**Bet**



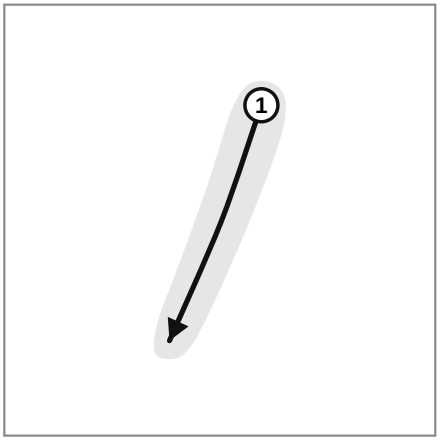

1 stroke

**Alef**



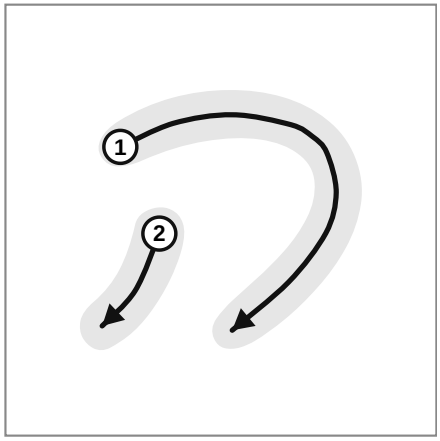

2 strokes

**Vav**



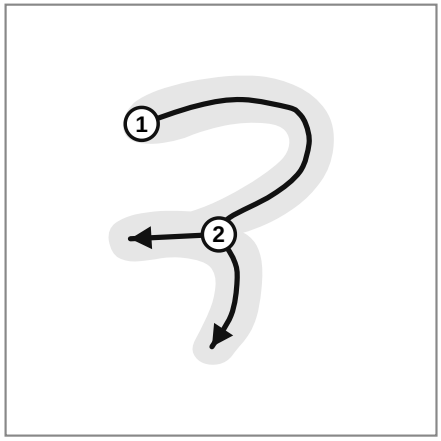

1 stroke

**He**



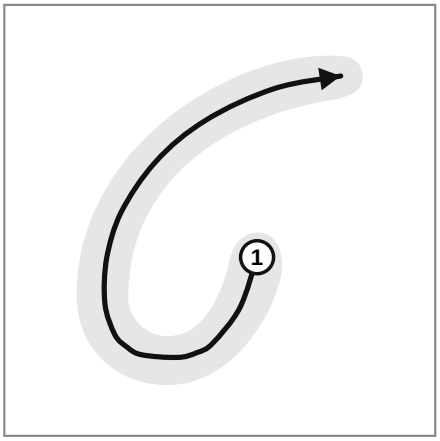

2 strokes

**Dalet**



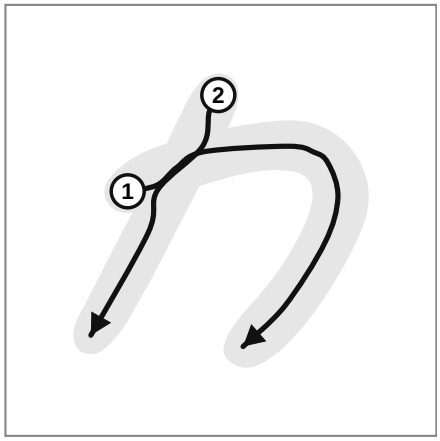

2 strokes

**Tet**



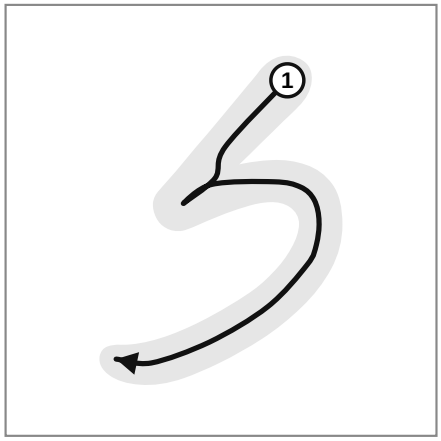

1 stroke

**Chet**




2 strokes

**Zayin**




1 stroke

☐ **1** Alef (1) *silent mime in a handstand; the vowel does the talking* /ʔ/



☐ **2** Bet (2) *a Bungalow with a Ball inside: B (no ball = Vacant = V)* /b/



☐ **2b** Vet (2) *Bet's house with no ball: Vacant, V* /v/



☐ **3** Gimel (3) *a Grumpy camel on the Go, one foot kicked out* /g/



☐ **4** Dalet (4) *a Diving board on one post: D (a Door frame from the side)* /d/



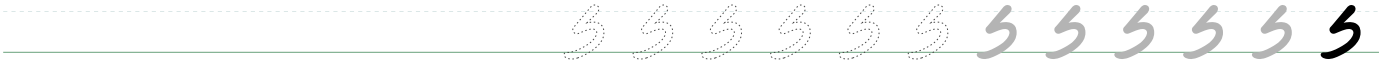
☐ **5** He (5) *a Hut with a Hole: Holler 'Hey!' through the gap* /h/



☐ **6** Vav (6) *a Vine hanging straight down, humming vvv; hooks 'and'* /v/



☐ **7** Zayin (7) *a Zapper: a dagger jabbed in the ground, zzzap* /z/



☐ **8** Chet (8) *a Closed gate, a cat hissing Chhh (Chanukah)* /χ/



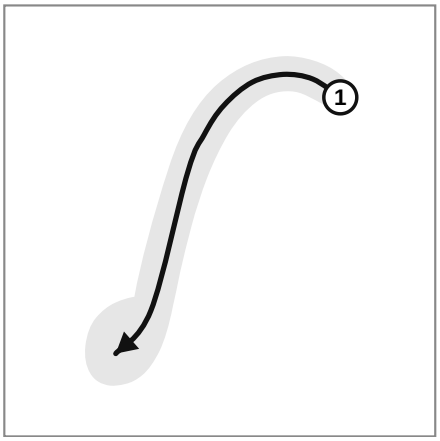
☐ **9** Tet (9) *a round-bellied Teapot full of Tea: T* /t/



## Letters 10-18: Yod, Kaf, Lamed, Mem, Nun, Samekh, Ayin, Pe, Tsadi

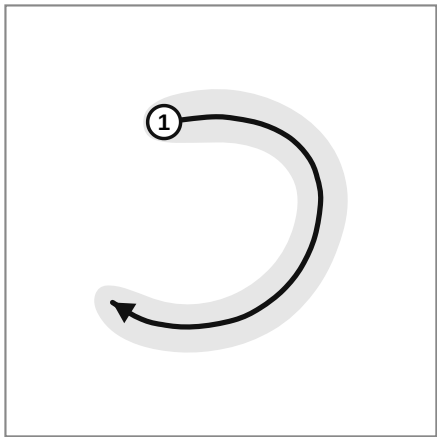
Circle with a number = where each stroke starts; arrowhead = where it ends. **Draft order, not teacher-reviewed.**

**Lamed**



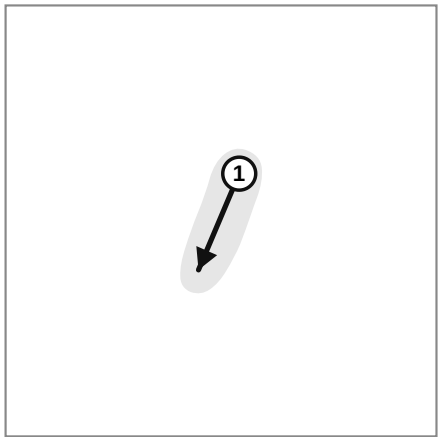

1 stroke

**Kaf**



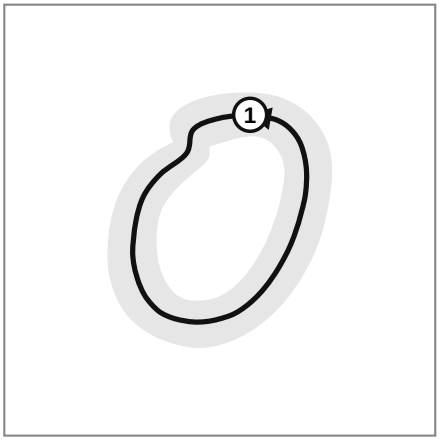

1 stroke

**Yod**



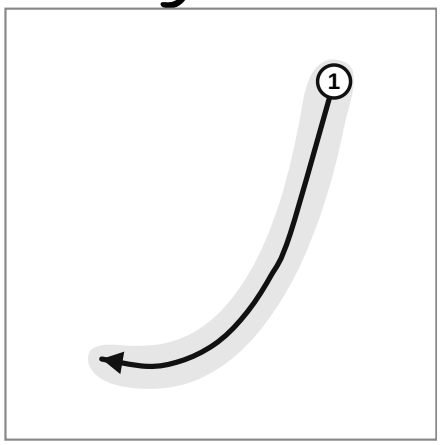

1 stroke

**Samekh**



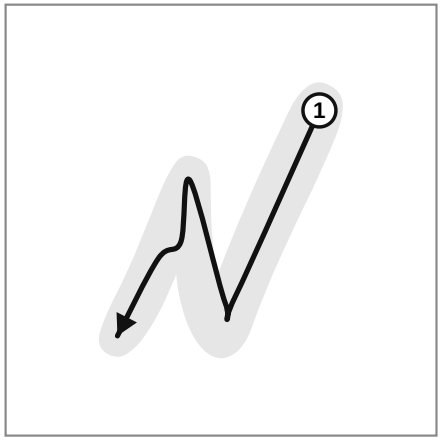

1 stroke

**Nun**



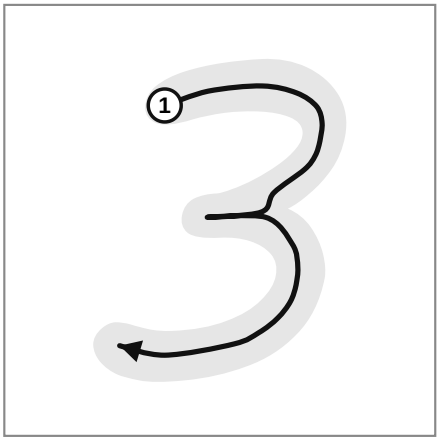

1 stroke

**Mem**



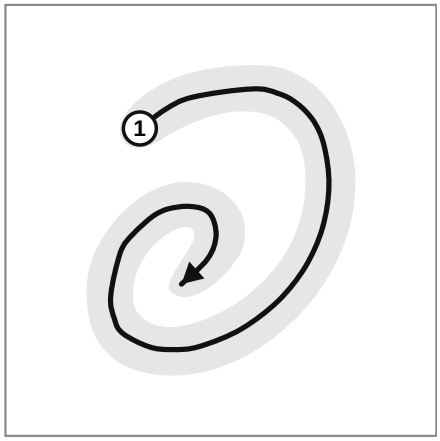

1 stroke

**Tsadi**



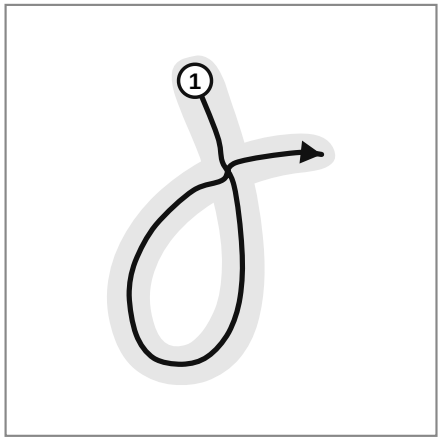

1 stroke

**Pe**




1 stroke

**Ayin**




1 stroke

☐ **10** Yod (10) *a Yo-yo bead floating at the top: the tiniest letter, Y* /j/



☐ **11** Kaf (20) *a Kitchen spoon with a Kernel (dot): K; empty = Kh* /k/



☐ **11b** Khaf (20) *Kaf's spoon, empty, blown on: Khhh* /χ/



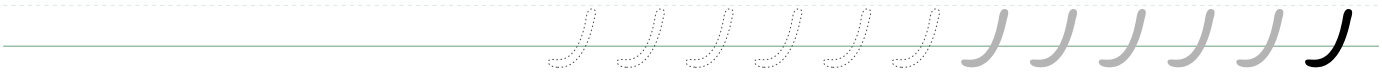
☐ **12** Lamed (30) *a tall Lamp post lighting everyone below: L for Learn* /l/



☐ **13** Mem (40) *a Mountain tent, flap open: Mmm (final mem = zipped shut)* /m/



☐ **14** Nun (50) *a Nun kneeling and bowed; final nun stands up straight* /n/



☐ **15** Samekh (60) *a Soft cushion you Sit on: Sss (round, no sharp corners)* /s/



☐ **16** Ayin (70) *an Eye winking in silence; you only hear the vowel* /ʔ/



☐ **17** Pe (80) *a mouth that Pops (dot) or Fluffs (no dot): P or F* /p/



☐ **17b** Fe (80) *Pe without the pop: a Feather floating, F* /f/



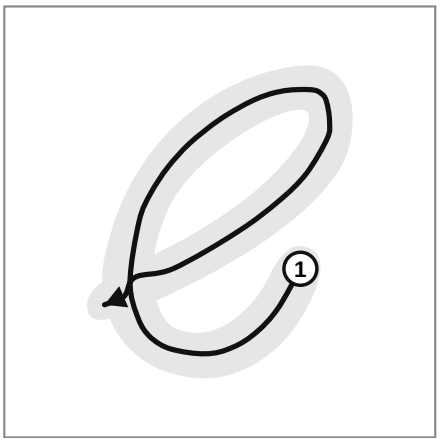
☐ **18** Tsadi (90) *a Tsetse fly with wings up on a slice of pizza: ts* /ts/



## Letters 19-27: Qof, Resh, Shin, Tav, Final Kaf, Final Mem, Final Nun, Final Pe, Final Tsadi

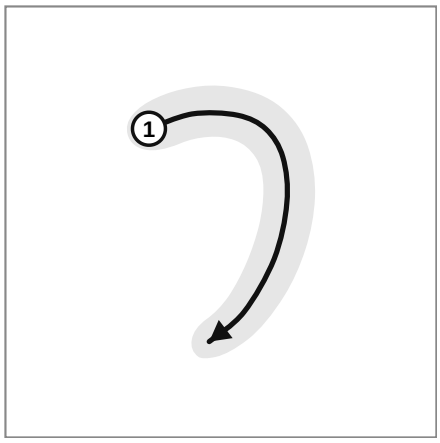
Circle with a number = where each stroke starts; arrowhead = where it ends. **Draft order, not teacher-reviewed.**

**Shin**



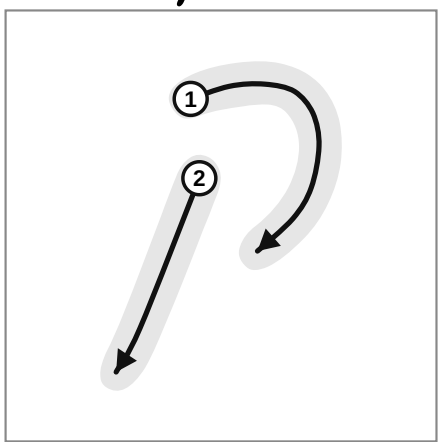

1 stroke

**Resh**



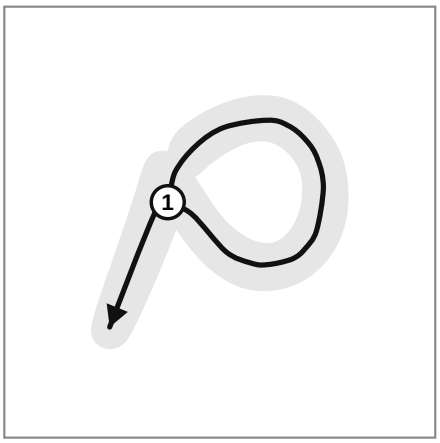

1 stroke

**Qof**



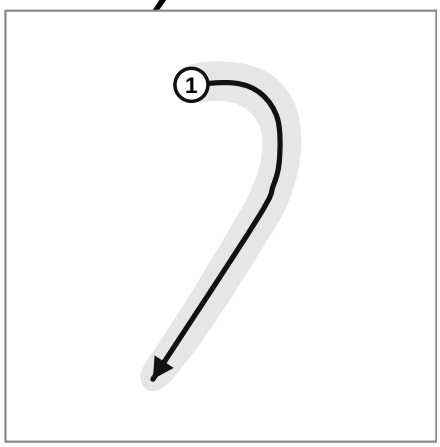

2 strokes

**Mem sofit**



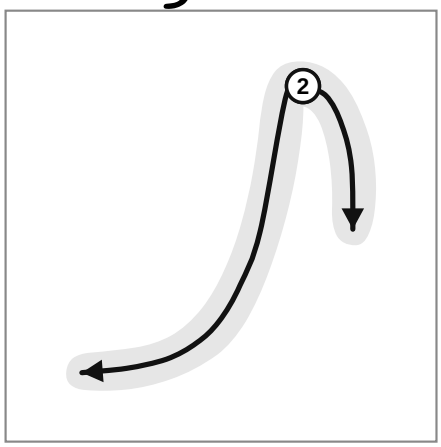

1 stroke

**Kaf sofit**



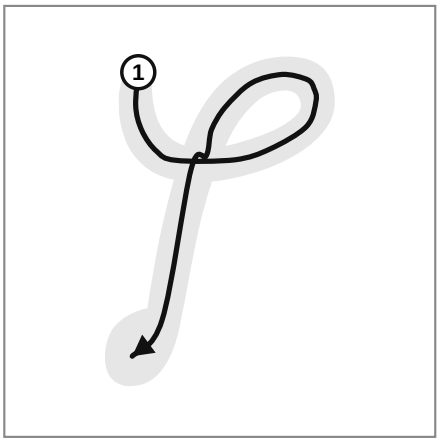

1 stroke

**Tav**



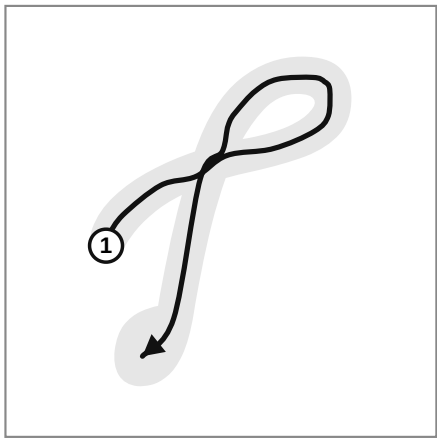

2 strokes

**Tsadi sofit**



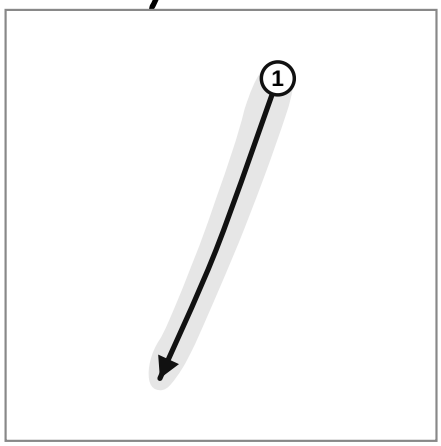

1 stroke

**Pe sofit**




1 stroke

**Nun sofit**




1 stroke

☐ **19** Qof (100) *a Kooky monkey hanging below the line: K* /k/



☐ **20** Resh (200) *a Round head from the side, no corner: Rrr (rosh = head)* /ʁ/



☐ **21** Shin (300) *three flames saying Shhh; dot left = Sin (sinister = left)* /ʃ/



☐ **21b** Sin (300) *Shin with the dot on the left: sinister = left, Sss* /s/



☐ **22** Tav (400) *a Table with a Toe tapping 'toda': T, the last letter* /t/



☐ **23** Kaf sofit (500*) *a King's cloak trailing on the floor: kh at word end* /k ~ χ/



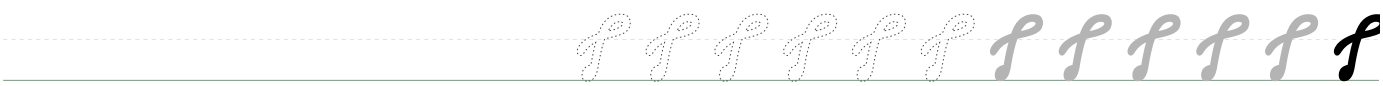
☐ **24** Mem sofit (600*) *the tent zipped shut at the end of the word: m* /m/



☐ **25** Nun sofit (700*) *the Nun standing up straight, coat to the floor: n* /n/



☐ **26** Pe sofit (800*) *a mouth with its tongue lolling out below the line: f* /p ~ f/



☐ **27** Tsadi sofit (900*) *a Tree: Y branches, long trunk into the land: ts* /ts/

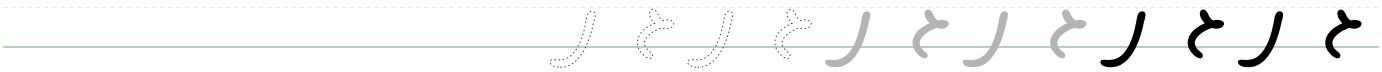


Letters that are easy to mix up. Trace a whole set in a row, then write the set from memory.

☐ Bet / Kaf / Pe — Bet's base sticks out to the right past the back; kaf is a single curved stroke like a reversed c; pe has a curl inside.



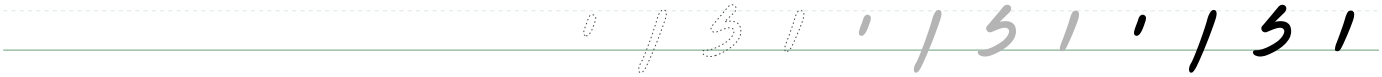
☐ Gimel / Nun — Gimel has a foot at the bottom left; nun has a flat base and no foot.



☐ Dalet / Resh / Kaf sofit — Dalet has a sharp corner and its top bar sticks out past the stem; resh is one rounded curve; final kaf is a resh with a long tail.



☐ Vav / Zayin / Nun sofit / Yod — Vav is a plain single stroke; zayin has a bar that sticks out to the right at the top; final nun is an extra-long vav that drops below the line; yod is short and floats at the top.



☐ He / Chet / Tav — He has a gap (window) at the upper left; chet is closed; tav has a foot that points left.



☐ Samekh / Mem sofit — Samekh is rounded; final mem is square.



☐ Tsadi / Ayin — Tsadi's second stroke comes from the top right; ayin's second stroke comes from the top left.



☐ Pe sofit / Tsadi sofit — Final pe curls inward at the top left; final tsadi forks upward like a Y.



☐ Shin / Sin — Shin has its dot on the upper right (sh); sin has its dot on the upper left (s). Dots are often left off in handwriting.



☐ Dalet / Resh — Rapid cursive dalet and resh look alike; dalet leans and is angled.



☐ Kaf sofit / Qof — Final kaf and qof transformed alike in cursive; qof has a descender at the left.

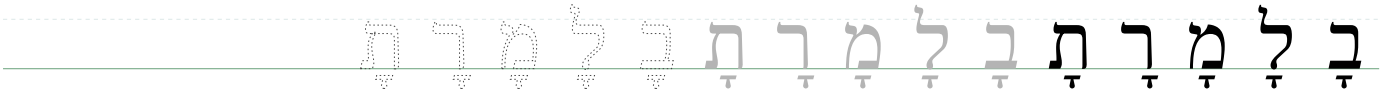


☐ Shin / Tsadi Shin's central stroke was lengthened like tsadi's right arm.

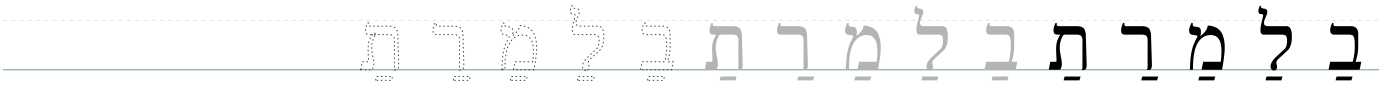


A consonant plus a vowel mark makes a syllable. Write the vowel marks small and exactly under (or above) the letter. Models use the print font so the marks are clear.

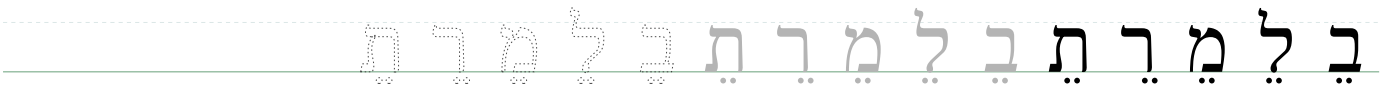
☐ a - kamatz a as in father (short, no glide) [a]



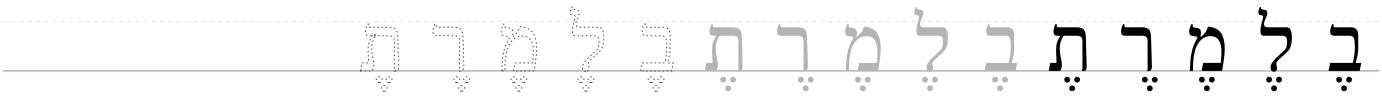
☐ a - patach a as in father [a]



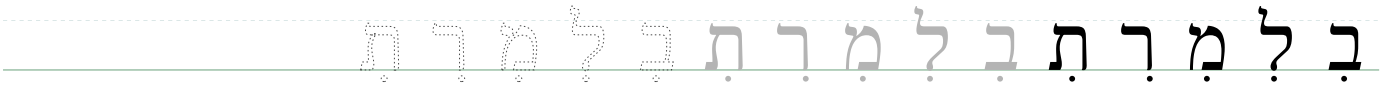
☐ e - tzere e as in bed (a few words and speakers say ei as in they) [ę]



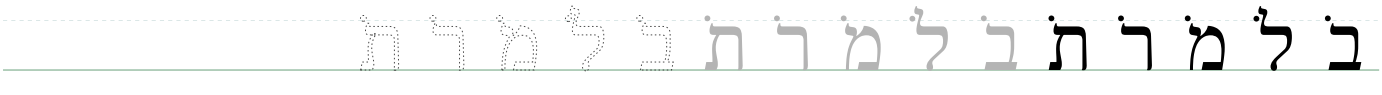
☐ e - segol e as in bed [ę]



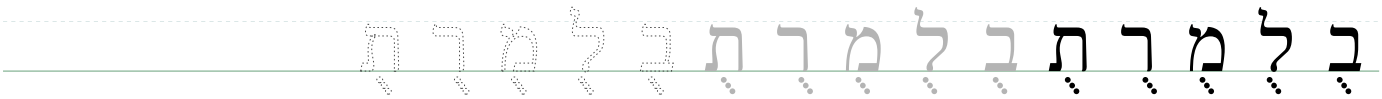
☐ i - chirik i as in machine (short) [i]



☐ o - cholam o as in for (no glide) [ǫ]



☐ u - kubutz oo as in boot (short) [u]



☐ u - shuruk oo as in boot [u]



Copy the word, then write it again in the blank space. Write how it sounds on the last line.

☐ **1** he returned

שָׁב 

sounds like: _____

☐ **2** Sabbath

שַׁבָּת 

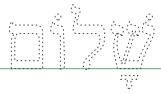
sounds like: _____

☐ **3** daughter

בַּת 

sounds like: _____

☐ **4** peace; hello

שָׁלוֹם 

sounds like: _____

☐ **5** to him

לוֹ 

sounds like: _____

☐ **6** in me

בִּי 

sounds like: _____

☐ **7** to me

לִי 

sounds like: _____

☐ **8** dad

אַבָּא 

sounds like: _____

☐ **9** he came

בָּא 

sounds like: _____

☐ **10** he was

הָיָה 

sounds like: _____

☐ **11** no; not

לֹא 

sounds like: _____

☐ **12** God

אֵל 

sounds like: _____

☐ **13** house of

בֵּית 

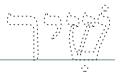
sounds like: _____

☐ **14** heart

לֵב 

sounds like: _____

☐ **15** song

שִׁיר 

sounds like: _____

☐ **16** mom

אִמָּא 

sounds like: _____

☐ **17** head

רֹאשׁ 

sounds like: _____

☐ **18** high

רָם 

sounds like: _____

☐ **19** because

כִּי 

sounds like: _____

☐ **20** to you

לָךְ 

sounds like: _____

☐ **21** you (m.)

אַתָּה 

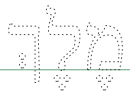
sounds like: _____

☐ **22** (object marker)

אֶת 

sounds like: _____

☐ **23** king

מֶלֶךְ 

sounds like: _____

☐ **24** son

בֵּן 

sounds like: _____